Xensible expert curriculum companion

Team AI Readiness Sprint

A structured readiness process for teams that want to identify useful AI opportunities before buying tools or launching policies.

Format	Two or three Zoom sessions with discovery worksheets and a readiness summary.
Level	Level 3: organizational readiness and use-case discovery
Audience	Small and midsize companies, nonprofits, health care teams, and institutions that need cautious, practical alignment.

Learner outcomes

- Map current work patterns, friction points, comfort levels, and risk concerns.
- Rank possible AI use cases by value, risk, readiness, and training needs.
- Clarify what to train, what to pilot, what to postpone, and what not to do.
- Create a practical readiness map before buying tools or announcing large AI initiatives.

Guiding questions

- Where are people already experimenting, and where are they hesitant?
- Which tasks create friction, delay, rework, or knowledge bottlenecks?
- Which ideas are low-risk training candidates, and which need stronger review before action?
- What should we learn before spending money on tools or vendors?

Readiness checks

- The team can distinguish training needs from implementation or procurement needs.
- Use cases are ranked by value, risk, readiness, and review burden.
- Sensitive-data concerns are named without implying legal or compliance guarantees.
- Next steps are limited enough to learn from safely.

Research-backed adoption practices

- Start discovery by asking where the business spends most of its time and what important work is being neglected.
- Combine top-down priorities with worker voice so use cases reflect real operations, not only leadership guesses.
- Score each idea by value, risk, readiness, data sensitivity, review burden, and learning required.
- Separate train, pilot, wait, avoid, and specialist-review decisions before spending money on tools.

Curriculum modules

Team context scan

We identify where AI curiosity already exists, where anxiety is highest, and where work is repetitive or overloaded.

Use-case discovery

Participants collect possible use cases and sort them by task type, data sensitivity, and expected value.

Risk and readiness scoring

We use a simple matrix to distinguish low-risk practice from decisions that need stronger review or policy.

Training path recommendation

The sprint ends with a practical next-step map for briefings, workshops, office hours, or a limited pilot.

Governance questions for later

The sprint names policy, procurement, privacy, and implementation questions that should be handled by the right internal owners.

First prompting lab

These short starter activities help learners experience prompt design before longer workflow projects. They are adapted from the activity patterns researched on Everybody Prompts and similar beginner practice formats.

Ask-for-a-prompt warmup (Pre-prompting)

Learners discover that prompting can begin by asking the model to help shape the prompt itself.

Build: A reusable prompt card with task, audience, context, constraints, output format, and review criteria.

Safe input: Use a public topic, fictional scenario, or harmless personal learning goal.

Starter prompt: I want to use AI for [safe topic or task], but I am not sure how to prompt well. Ask me up to five clarifying questions, then give me three prompt options: quick, structured, and advanced. Include what each prompt is good for and what I should check afterward.

Structured research table (Basic research prompting)

Students learn to ask for organized output instead of accepting a long, shapeless answer.

Build: A comparison table with columns the learner specified, plus a list of claims to verify.

Safe input: Use a public topic such as renewable energy, storage devices, local history, or a general product category.

Starter prompt: Create a beginner-friendly research table about [public topic]. Use columns for concept, short explanation, practical use, common confusion, and what to verify in reliable sources. After the table, suggest three better follow-up questions.

Timeline builder (Chronological organization)

Students see how prompt format changes understanding by turning a topic into sequence, development, and context.

Build: A chronological timeline with significance notes and uncertainty flags.

Safe input: Use public historical, technical, cultural, or organizational topics.

Starter prompt: Create a chronological timeline for [public topic]. Include year or period, event, why it mattered, what changed afterward, and confidence level. Mark anything that needs source checking.

Email tone trio (Business email drafting)

Learners experience AI as a writing partner while keeping voice, promises, and final judgment human-led.

Build: Three email versions, a tone comparison, and a send-before-review checklist.

Safe input: Use a fictional or sanitized email scenario with no customer, patient, employee, financial, or proprietary details.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional email scenario, draft three versions: concise, warm, and more formal. Explain what changed in each version, recommend one, and list facts, promises, names, dates, and tone choices a human should confirm before sending: [scenario].

Image observation drill (Image description)

Students distinguish visible evidence from inference, uncertainty, and possible overclaiming.

Build: A two-column observation table separating what is visible from what is inferred.

Safe input: Use a public-domain, stock, classroom, or non-sensitive image. Avoid faces or private settings unless permissions are clear.

Starter prompt: Describe this image for a careful learner. Separate visible details from inferences. Add a table with observation, evidence in the image, confidence, and what should not be assumed. Finish with three questions a human reviewer should ask.

Career fit map (Career research)

Learners practice giving context, asking for options, and requesting useful decision criteria.

Build: A career option table with fit reasons, education paths, tradeoffs, and next questions.

Safe input: Use a fictional profile or a sanitized personal summary that excludes private employer data, compensation, references, and confidential projects.

Starter prompt: Using this safe career profile, suggest career directions in a table with role, why it may fit, skills to build, typical education or training path, tradeoffs, and next research questions. Do not make the decision for me: [profile].

Proof-bank resume drill (Resume creation)

Students learn to turn scattered experience into defensible claims and then ask for critique.

Build: Six resume bullets, proof bank, critique table, and claims-to-evidence checklist.

Safe input: Use a fictional or sanitized work history without private employer details, references, compensation, or confidential outcomes.

Starter prompt: Turn this sanitized work history into a proof bank and six resume bullet options. For each bullet, list the evidence needed to support it, possible overstatement risk, and one stronger revision. Flag anything that sounds inflated: [work history].

Brand connotation check (Branding feedback)

Learners see how AI can brainstorm associations while human judgment still checks audience, culture, and evidence.

Build: A naming or messaging table with positive associations, risks, audience fit, and questions to test.

Safe input: Use fictional brand names, public examples, or early ideas that are not confidential.

Starter prompt: Evaluate these fictional brand or project names for connotations. Create a table with name, positive associations, possible drawbacks, audience fit, words to avoid, and questions we should test with real people: [names].

Survey cleanup and format (Survey construction)

Students learn to ask for editing, consistency, and application-ready formatting in one clear request.

Build: A cleaned survey list plus a format-ready version for a form tool or spreadsheet.

Safe input: Use fictional survey items or public workshop feedback questions. Avoid private personnel, patient, customer, or sensitive demographic data.

Starter prompt: Clean up these fictional survey items. Fix grammar, remove leading language, make the scale consistent, and return two outputs: a numbered review table and a form-ready list in the format [Required] [Question type] Question text: [items].

Chart storyboard (Chart creation)

Learners separate the data question, chart type, audience, and caveats before asking for a visual.

Build: A chart plan with data needed, recommended chart type, annotation ideas, and cautions.

Safe input: Use public data, fictional data, or a small hand-written sample. Do not use sensitive spreadsheets in public tools.

Starter prompt: Help me plan a chart for [public or fictional data topic]. Recommend chart type, needed columns, sample data structure, title, labels, annotations, caveats, and three checks before presenting the chart.

Cloze quiz maker (Quiz generation)

Students practice precise output instructions, distractor quality, and iterative repair.

Build: A short cloze quiz in table format with answer key, distractors, and a quality check.

Safe input: Use a public article, textbook excerpt you have rights to use, or original instructional text.

Starter prompt: Create a five-item cloze quiz from this public or original text. Return a table with sentence, missing term, three plausible distractors, correct answer, and explanation. Then critique the quiz for ambiguity and weak distractors: [text].

Lesson or page outline (Lesson plans and website pages)

Learners see how AI can structure material into a usable outline before any polished writing begins.

Build: A one-hour lesson plan or one-page website outline with sections, examples, activities, and review notes.

Safe input: Use public topic notes, fictional program descriptions, or sanitized learning goals.

Starter prompt: Turn this safe topic into a one-hour lesson plan or one-page website outline. Include audience, learning goals, section sequence, examples, activity ideas, plain-language explanations, and review questions. Mark assumptions and missing information: [topic notes].

Session flow

Discover

Interview or workshop with leaders and users to surface real work patterns, pain points, and comfort levels.

Inventory

Collect possible use cases and describe each one by task type, data sensitivity, value, and review needs.

Score

Rank ideas with a simple value, risk, readiness, and training-needs rubric.

Sort

Place ideas into train, pilot, wait, or avoid categories.

Recommend

Translate findings into a short next-step roadmap for training, office hours, or a narrow pilot.

Practice labs

20-task time scan

Build: a ranked list of recurring tasks with time spent, friction, neglected work, data sensitivity, and review owner. Use: generalized workshop notes. Do: score frequency, pain, value, sensitivity, and burden. Check: value opportunities come from real time sinks or neglected work.

Use-case card sorting

Build: use-case cards with user, task, input, output, value, risk, readiness, review owner, and next step. Use: generalized workflow descriptions. Do: sort into train, discover, pilot, wait, avoid, or specialist review. Check: specificity and caution.

Value-risk board

Build: a 2x2 board by practical value and risk or review burden. Use: sanitized use-case cards. Do: plot, discuss risk reduction, and pick two low-risk training examples. Check: the board slows premature buying.

30-day readiness memo

Build: a one-page memo naming what to train, test, postpone, and assign to internal owners. Use: anonymized findings. Do: summarize candidates and higher-risk items. Check: no promised savings or implementation outcomes.

1-2 hour utility projects

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

How to choose a strong first project

- Real work, safe input: choose a task learners recognize, then substitute public, fictional, or sanitized material.
- Named walk-away artifact: produce a file, table, checklist, brief, agenda, glossary, recipe card, or other object.
- Visible human judgment: require the learner to check claims, reject weak output, revise tone, name uncertainty, or decide what stays human-led.
- Transferable next use: teach a repeatable pattern such as adding context, requesting structure, comparing alternatives, verifying claims, documenting the recipe, and trying it again.

Public Article Learning Kit (60-75 minutes)

Turn one public article into a tutor session and a usable study packet.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page explainer, eight-term glossary, five-question quiz, misconception list, and verification table.

Safe input: Use a public article, help page, announcement, or topic summary. Avoid private client, patient, employee, financial, legal, or proprietary material.

- Paste or summarize one public source and state your current knowledge level.
- Ask for an explainer, glossary, examples, and common misconceptions.
- Create a five-question quiz and answer it before looking at the answer key.
- Mark every claim that needs source checking before you share or rely on it.

Starter prompt: Use this public source to create a learning kit for a smart beginner: [public source or topic]. Produce a one-page explainer, eight-term glossary, three examples, common misconceptions, a five-question quiz with answer key, and a verification table listing claims I should check in reliable sources.

Decision Brief in a Box (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to structure a decision without handing the decision away.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page decision brief with criteria, option table, assumption register, pre-mortem, and next-evidence checklist.

Safe input: Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Name two or three options, the decision deadline, constraints, and what success would look like.
- Ask for a weighted criteria table and force the model to show its assumptions.
- Run a pre-mortem for the most tempting option and a second pass for the safest option.
- Write three human-only judgment questions you will answer before acting.

Starter prompt: Help me build a decision brief without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Include weighted criteria, an option comparison table, assumptions, likely failure modes, missing evidence, who should be consulted, and three final human judgment questions.

Meeting-to-Momentum Kit (60-90 minutes)

Convert a rough meeting idea into a focused agenda and follow-through packet.

Walk-away artifact: A timed agenda, participant prep note, decision log template, action-item table, and follow-up email draft.

Safe input: Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Describe the meeting purpose, attendees by role, time available, and desired output.
- Ask for a timed agenda with decisions, discussion prompts, and parking-lot items.
- Create a follow-up template with owners, due dates, unresolved questions, and confirmation language.
- Delete or rewrite anything that sounds like a promise, personnel judgment, or confidential detail.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a meeting kit: timed agenda, prep questions by role, likely tensions, decision log, action-item table, and follow-up email draft. Mark assumptions and anything a human should confirm before sending: [context].

Before-and-After Writing Studio (60 minutes)

Use AI as an editor, not a ghostwriter, and leave with a cleaner real draft.

Walk-away artifact: A revised email, memo, bio, announcement, or article with a change log, tone rationale, and final review checklist.

Safe input: Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Paste a safe rough draft and name the audience, purpose, tone, and length limit.
- Ask for two alternative revisions: one clearer and one warmer or more concise.
- Have AI critique the revision for unsupported claims, missing context, and awkward tone.
- Make the final edits yourself and keep a before-and-after note on what improved.

Starter prompt: Revise this safe rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone and a [length] limit. Give me two versions, explain the changes, then critique the stronger version for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything I should verify before sending: [safe draft].

Research Launch Board (90-120 minutes)

Plan the research before the rabbit hole opens.

Walk-away artifact: A research board with question clusters, search strings, source ladder, opposing views, red flags, and claim-check table.

Safe input: Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Start with one broad public question and ask AI to break it into subquestions.
- Generate search strings, source categories, keywords to avoid, and missing perspectives.
- Ask for a claim-check table with columns for claim, source needed, confidence, and next action.
- Use the board to search actual sources; do not treat the model output as evidence.

Starter prompt: Help me build a research launch board for [public topic]. Create question clusters, search strings, source types, likely blind spots, opposing perspectives, red flags, and a claim-check table. Do not invent citations or make final claims without sources.

Workflow Recipe Card (90-120 minutes)

Turn one repeated task into a reusable recipe your future self can follow.

Walk-away artifact: A recipe card with trigger, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, owner, time saved estimate, and stop signs.

Safe input: Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Write the current task steps from trigger to final output.

- Mark which inputs are safe, which must be generalized, and which should not enter a public tool.
- Ask AI to propose a prompt sequence and review checkpoints for the safest useful slice.
- Test the recipe with one fictional example and revise the steps until they are repeatable.

Starter prompt: Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include trigger, user, safe inputs, prompt sequence, expected output, review checkpoints, human owner, estimated time saved, risks, stop signs, and when not to use AI.

Professional Proof Portfolio (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to turn scattered experience into concrete positioning you can defend.

Walk-away artifact: A 150-word bio, six resume bullets, proof bank, interview answer outlines, and claims-to-evidence checklist.

Safe input: Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Write a sanitized inventory of roles, strengths, projects, and outcomes you can discuss publicly.
- Ask AI to draft positioning options and separate claims from evidence.
- Create resume bullets and interview outlines, then remove anything inflated or unverifiable.
- Practice three interview questions and revise the language until it sounds true in your own voice.

Starter prompt: Using this sanitized professional summary, help me build a proof portfolio. Draft a 150-word bio, six resume bullet options, a proof bank, three interview answer outlines, and a claims-to-evidence checklist. Flag anything that sounds inflated or needs stronger evidence: [summary].

Seven-Day Action Plan (60-75 minutes)

Turn a vague goal into a week of small, scheduled actions.

Walk-away artifact: A seven-day plan with calendar blocks, next actions, obstacle responses, accountability note, and end-of-week review.

Safe input: Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, available time, constraints, and what usually derails progress.
- Ask for a one-week plan with daily actions no longer than 45 minutes.
- Have AI identify likely obstacles and create if-then responses.
- Put the first two actions on your calendar and delete anything unrealistic.

Starter prompt: Help me turn this safe goal into a seven-day action plan: [safe goal]. Ask up to five clarifying questions if needed, then create calendar blocks, daily next actions under 45 minutes, obstacle responses, an accountability note, and an end-of-week review checklist.

Tangible cases

Nonprofit intake backlog

Situation: A nonprofit team spends too much time sorting public inquiries, drafting first responses, and preparing internal handoffs.

Learner task: Build a friction map, use-case cards, and train/pilot/wait/avoid sort without treating intake as an automation project.

Starter prompt: Analyze this fictional nonprofit intake workflow. Create a friction map, use-case cards, data sensitivity notes, review-owner list, and train/discover/pilot/wait/avoid recommendation for each idea: [fictional workflow].

Clinic admin documentation

Situation: A health care organization wants to improve admin templates but is cautious about patient privacy and medical claims.

Learner task: Create a safe-practice list, internal-owner list, and avoid list for admin documentation improvement.

Starter prompt: Given this fictional clinic admin workflow, create three tables: low-risk AI training ideas, items requiring private systems or internal owner approval, and items to avoid. Include input, output, review owner, and why. Do not provide medical, legal, compliance, or cybersecurity assurances: [fictional workflow].

Customer support knowledge gaps

Situation: A small company has scattered public FAQ pages and repeated support questions.

Learner task: Score possible support use cases and create a 30-day training-first next-step map before any tool purchase.

Starter prompt: Turn these fictional support pain points into use-case cards. For each card, include task, user, input, output, value, risk, readiness, review owner, recommended next step, and a 30-day training-first experiment if appropriate: [pain points].

Prompt library

Friction map

Help a team map workflow friction. Ask for recurring tasks, delays, rework, handoffs, knowledge bottlenecks, tasks being neglected, time spent, data sensitivity, and review owners. Then produce a ranked friction map and likely AI training opportunities.

Use-case card

Create a use-case card for this AI idea with user, task, safe input, expected output, current pain, value, risk, data sensitivity, review owner, readiness, training need, and smallest next experiment: [idea].

Value-risk scoring

Score these AI ideas from 1 to 5 for value, risk, readiness, review burden, and data sensitivity. Explain each score, name missing evidence, and sort the ideas into train, discover, pilot, wait, avoid, or specialist review: [ideas].

Readiness summary

Draft a cautious one-page readiness summary for leaders. Include top time sinks, neglected work worth exploring, training candidates, ideas to postpone, items needing specialist review, owner roles, and the smallest practical next step: [findings].

Materials to develop

- Team readiness worksheet
- Use-case scoring rubric
- AI norms discussion guide
- Recommended next-step summary template
- Use-case card deck
- Train, pilot, wait, avoid decision sheet

Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Use-case value/risk grid
- Team adoption pathway from discovery to practice
- Readiness map from friction points to training path
- AI adoption value scan: time spent, neglected work, value, risk, next step

Follow-up work

- Choose two low-risk training candidates and one idea to postpone.
- Schedule the right briefing or workshop for the highest-priority audience.
- Review the map monthly as team fluency and tool options change.

Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.